

THE EXTERIOR

The F-86A was an extremely well-proportioned design. The all-metal, flush-riveted, oval-section fuselage was aerodynamically efficient. Because the engine was located within the fuselage and fed by a large intake in the nose, the Sabre did not use drag-inducing engine pods or nacelles on the airframe, making it highly maneuverable. The mainwheels had to be retracted into the fuselage, which gave the aircraft a rather narrow-track undercarriage.

1. Painted emblem 2. One of three gunports on port side 3. Recessed step for cockpit access 4. Hydraulic nose wheel 5. V-shaped windshield (rounded on prototype) 6. Pitot tube mounted on starboard wing 7. Formation light set into starboard wing tip 8. Fuel filler's maximum capacity is 105 gallons (397 liters) 9. Port lateral airbrake 10. Landing light (retracted) in wing 11. Access panel for emergency engine disconnect 12. External power receptacle and fuel filler on starboard side 13. Stainless steel shroud for jetpipe 14. Fuel dump mast at rear of fuselage 15. Jetpipe

